First Sunday after Christmas Day

Isaiah 63:7-9 * Psalm 148
Hebrews 2:10-18 * Matthew 2:13-23

Prayer

"*Heavenly Father, we thank You for sending Your Son, Jesus Christ, to bring light and hope to our world.Help us to remember the wonder of His birth and to feel the joy of the angels and shepherds.*

Fill us with Your Holy Spirit that the light of Christ may be enkindled in our hearts and shine forth in our lives, illuminating our path as we move into the New Year. Guide our thoughts and our spirits today, and in the days to come, that we may reflect the love and compassion You have shown us through Jesus Christ. Amen"

Opening

1. How do we see Joseph's trust in God through his obedience to the angel's commands?

2. What can we learn from Joseph's prompt response to God's guidance, even when it was difficult or inconvenient?

3. Share a time when you had to trust God in an uncertain situation. How did it turn out?

Engaging the Text

1. How can we cultivate deeper faith and trust in God during uncertain times in our own lives, mirroring the faith of the Holy Family?

2. In what ways can we be like Joseph in seeking God's guidance and obeying His commands in our daily lives?

3. How can the story of Jesus' early life be used to share the Gospel with others and inspire them to seek and worship Jesus?

Application Activities

Refugee Advocacy and Prayer
This activity connects the story directly to a real-world justice issue.

Activity:

- Research a local or international organization that supports refugees.
- Collect a special offering for the organization during your group meeting.
- Find a news story about refugees today and read it as a group.

Discussion and prayer: Pray together for refugees and for justice. Write sentence prayers around the news story for their needs.